

Rising Tides

Lead Targeting Profile & Scoring Matrix

This document defines exactly who Rising Tides sells to, what makes a lead high-value, and how to filter 2M+ leads down to the 200 that matter.

1. Ideal Client Profile (ICP)

Tier 1: Major Label Imprints (Highest Value)

Label-level relationships where a single point of contact controls budgets for 10-50+ artists.

Attribute	Criteria
Type	Major label imprint, division, or subsidiary
Parent Groups	Warner Music Group, Sony Music, Universal Music Group
Budget Range	\$5K-\$50K per campaign
Decision Maker	A&R, Digital Marketing Director, VP of Marketing
Buying Signal	Active release schedule (1+ releases/month across roster)
Why They Buy	Need scale fast - 20-50 creators per campaign, can't manage in-house

Existing Relationships: Warner Records (51 artists), Empire (3), Atlantic (1), Columbia (2), Sony Music, UMG, Mega House Music

Expansion Pattern: Once RT lands one artist at a label, the play is servicing more of that roster.

Tier 2: Large Independent Labels

Mid-size labels with real marketing budgets but no in-house UGC team.

Attribute	Criteria
Type	Independent label, 20-200 artists on roster
Revenue Indicator	Multiple artists with 100K+ Spotify monthly listeners
Budget Range	\$1.5K-\$15K per campaign
Decision Maker	Label owner, marketing manager, or artist manager
Buying Signal	Regular release cadence + growing Spotify numbers
Why They Buy	Know they need TikTok/IG but don't have creator relationships

Examples: Nettwerk, 300 Entertainment, Quality Control, Top Dawg, Stones Throw, Secretly Canadian, Merge, Sub Pop

Tier 3: Artist Managers & Management Companies

Attribute	Criteria
Type	Management company or individual manager
Artist Count	3-10 artists under management
Budget Range	\$1.5K-\$10K per campaign

Decision Maker	Manager directly
Buying Signal	Artist hitting inflection point (radio, sync, festival)
Why They Buy	Need promotional firepower for a specific release moment

Tier 4: Independent Artists (Course Funnel)

Attribute	Criteria
Type	Self-releasing independent artist
Follower Range	1K-50K across platforms
Budget Range	\$997 (course) or \$1.5K (starter campaign)
Buying Signal	Active on socials, releasing music, asking "how do I grow?"
Why They Buy	Education-first - learn before they buy services

2. Artist Targeting Filters

When scanning a label's roster to identify which artists RT should pitch campaigns for:

Sweet Spot Artist Profile

Metric	Range	Why
Spotify Monthly Listeners	10K - 500K	Below 10K = budget too small. Above 500K = in-house team
Spotify Followers	5K - 200K	Follower-to-listener ratio = real fanbase indicator
TikTok Followers	Any (including 0)	Labels need TikTok because artist has no presence
Instagram Followers	5K+	Below 5K = label not investing in this artist
Release Recency	Within 90 days OR upcoming	No release on horizon = no pitch
Genre	Hip-hop, R&B, Pop, Indie, Afrobeats, Latin, Electronic	RT has proven results here

Disqualifying Signals

- Artist has >1M Spotify ML AND >500K TikTok followers (already has a team)
- Artist hasn't released in 12+ months (dormant)
- Label does everything in-house (e.g., HYBE, some major pop divisions)
- Artist in active controversy or legal dispute
- Genre: classical, jazz, or worship (no creator network)

Priority Multipliers

Signal	Multiplier	Reasoning
We already work with this label	3x	Warm intro, proven trust
Upcoming release (14-28 days)	2.5x	Perfect timing window
Recent sync/playlist/press placement	2x	Label is investing, momentum is real
No TikTok but strong Spotify	2x	Obvious pain point we solve
Same A&R; as another RT client	1.5x	Relationship leverage
Genre match with top RT campaigns	1.5x	Can show case studies

3. Campaign Type Matching

Campaign Type	Price	Best For	Pitch Angle
Sound Campaign	\$1,500+	Single releases, playlist pushes	Drive streams & saves through authentic creator content
Page Management	\$1.5-2.5K/mo	Ongoing presence, consistent content	We run your TikTok/IG like it's our own page

Full Campaign Package	\$5K-\$15K	Major releases, album rollouts, tour promo	20-50 creators, multi-platform, managed end-to-end
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4. Lead Scoring Rubric (0-100)

Factor	Weight	0 pts	25 pts	50 pts	75 pts	100 pts
Label Relationship	30%	Unknown	Same parent group	Past client	Active (diff division)	Active (same team)
Timing	25%	No release	60+ days out	30-60 days	14-28 days	This week
Genre Fit	15%	No experience	Adjacent genre	Done 1-2x	Strong track record	Top-performing
Artist Tier Fit	15%	<5K or >1M ML	5-10K ML	10-50K ML	50-200K ML	200-500K ML
Budget Indicator	15%	Indie, no backing	Small indie label	Mid-size indie	Major subsidiary	Major direct

Score Thresholds:

- **80-100:** Hot lead - draft outreach immediately
- **60-79:** Warm lead - queue for weekly outreach batch
- **40-59:** Watch list - track cadence, revisit when timing improves
- **Below 40:** Pass - don't spend time on this

5. Outreach Voice & Approach

Do:

- Reference specific releases by name
- Mention shared connections
- Cite real numbers from past campaigns
- Keep it brief - under 150 words
- One clear ask ("15-min call about [Artist]'s next release?")

Don't:

- Generic "we're a marketing agency" opener
- Mass-email feel (no Dear Sir/Madam)
- Mention pricing in first outreach (qualify first)
- Overclaim ("we guarantee viral" - never)
- Name-drop clients without permission

Subject Line Patterns:

- *{Artist} x Rising Tides - {Release} campaign?*
- *Quick thought on {Artist}'s TikTok rollout*
- *Re: {Shared Connection} mentioned you*
- *{Label} campaign ideas for Q{X}*

6. Data Sources for Enrichment

Source	What It Provides	Refresh Rate
CRM (Labels DB)	Known labels, contacts, relationship status	Real-time

CRM (Artists DB)	Artists we've worked with, by label	Real-time
Spotify API	Release dates, monthly listeners, followers, genre, label name	Daily
Gmail/Email	Past threads with contacts (relationship history)	On-demand
Campaign Tracker	Past performance data (CPM, views, budget)	On-demand

Data gaps (manual fill or scraping needed): Label A&R; emails, artist manager contacts, budget history per label, social channel URLs

7. Lead Funnel (Market Sizing)

Filters applied in sequence - each stage narrows the pool:

Volume	Filter Stage
2,000,000	Total leads (raw database)
~200,000	Music industry only (labels, managers, artists, A&R;)
~80,000	Active release schedule (past 12 months)
~40,000	Genre match (hip-hop, R&B;, pop, indie, afrobeats, latin, electronic)
~15,000	Artist tier fit (10K-500K Spotify monthly listeners)
~5,000	Has label backing OR management with budget indicators
~1,500	Upcoming release window (next 60 days)
~200-400	Relationship proximity (shared label, warm intro possible)
50-100	Final scored leads per cycle (score >60)

Target output: 50-100 qualified leads per week - reviewable in 15 minutes, top 10-20 get outreach.

8. Competitive Positioning

Competitor Type	Their Pitch	RT's Counter
Big agencies (Grin, CreatorIQ)	Enterprise dashboards, data	"We're operators, not dashboards. 131 creators, hands-on."
Freelance managers	Cheap, one person	"We run 55+ campaigns simultaneously with a dedicated team."
In-house label teams	Control	"We bring 100+ creator relationships you don't have in-house."
Other boutique agencies	Similar claims	"67.8M total views. \$0.50-\$1.00 CPM. We show receipts."

RT's Unfair Advantages:

- Real creator relationships (not a database) - 131 active creators
- Music-industry-only focus (not a generalist shop)
- Mon Rovia as living proof (2M+ Facebook, 1M IG, 1M TikTok - built with our own methods)
- \$100K/month revenue, 55+ simultaneous campaigns, 8-person team
- Sub-\$1.00 CPM track record across 67.8M total campaign views